

What follows are suggestions for the draft of ***Voluntary Standards For Election Audits – A Practical Guide***:

1. On page 3, under the heading **Example: Auditing Activities Before, During and After an Election**, the description for the box titled, “Compliance or Procedural Audit” should be revised to say, “...procedures were followed ***throughout the year***.” That is, they should not be limited to “throughout the election.” The internal control procedures covering voter registration, vetting, addition to the voter rolls, changes to voter status, posting of voter activity to history, **list maintenance**, and all the other related activities should be monitored throughout the year.
2. Generally, under Independence, the audits should not be under the “Direction of the chief election official,” but by an independent audit committee, funded by the state, but reporting directly to the election committees of the legislature (joint house and senate, if bicameral). The election official should be involved to facilitate planning, timing and ensuring resources are available, but should not control or direct the processs.
3. On page 25 there is a table describing, **“Differences in Audit Staffing.”** The description under “Non-Partisan” is incorrect. In no way does not being required to disclose biases equate to neutrality. That idea is not even a myth, it is a falsehood. Please change that to **“Party affiliations, if any, are not disclosed”** or similar language that is not misleading.